LAUNCH PLAYBOOK · ETEL GROUP · HAWASSA

ETEL
Delivery & Ride

A step-by-step plan to take ETEL Delivery & Ride from a working platform to a paying business in Hawassa: who to sign, what to build, how money moves, what to measure, and what can go wrong.

MODEL	COMMISSION	PAYMENTS	LAUNCH
Two-sided marketplace	5% per merchant order	Telebirr, bank, EtelPay	One district first



THE BIG PICTURE

Five phases from setup to scale

Timings are planning assumptions. Move to the next phase only when the exit check of the current one is met.

WEEKS 1–2

Foundations

- Legal, licences, bank and Telebirr accounts
- Pricing and commission rules set
- Support line and team roles

WEEKS 3–6

Build supply

- Sign first merchants
- Recruit and vet couriers and drivers
- Train on the apps

WEEKS 7–10

Soft launch

- One district, invited customers
- Fix issues daily
- Test payouts end to end

WEEKS 11–20

Grow

- Open the city, public campaigns
- Promo codes and referrals
- Add merchant tools

MONTH 6+

Scale

- Cross-sell Gebeya and Taxi
- Corporate accounts
- Plan the next city

STEP BY STEP

Ten steps to launch

Tick items as you finish them. Progress is saved in this browser only.

Overall progress 0% (0/60)

01 Lock the legal and financial base

OWNER: MANAGEMENT WEEKS 1–2

OUTPUT: LICENCES, ACCOUNTS, CONTRACTS

- [ ] Confirm business licence and any transport or delivery permits
- [ ] Open the bank account and confirm Telebirr merchant access
- [ ] Draft merchant, courier and driver agreements
- [ ] Decide who is responsible for finance, support and operations
- [ ] Set up accounting and daily reconciliation
- [ ] Buy insurance where required

02 Set pricing and commission

OWNER: FINANCE WEEKS 1–2 OUTPUT: PRICE SHEET

- [ ] Confirm the 5% merchant commission
- [ ] Set delivery fees by Hawassa zone
- [ ] Set ride fares: metered and fixed
- [ ] Decide courier and driver earning share
- [ ] Write refund and cancellation rules
- [ ] Enter all rates in the admin settings

03 Choose the launch district

OWNER: OPERATIONS WEEKS 2–3 OUTPUT: DISTRICT MAP AND TARGET LIST

- [ ] Pick one dense district with many restaurants and shops
- [ ] List 60 candidate merchants and rank them
- [ ] Map pickup points and typical delivery distances
- [ ] Check road and traffic patterns
- [ ] Identify taxi stands and hotels for ride pickups
- [ ] Set the district border and delivery radius

04 Sign the first merchants

OWNER: MERCHANT SUCCESS WEEKS 3–6 OUTPUT: 20 SIGNED MERCHANTS

- [ ] Visit in person with a one-page offer
- [ ] Load menus, items and photos into the platform
- [ ] Give each merchant a login and a short training
- [ ] Agree preparation times
- [ ] Explain payouts and the 5% commission clearly
- [ ] Leave a printed quick guide and a support number

05 Recruit and vet couriers and drivers

OWNER: OPERATIONS WEEKS 3–6 OUTPUT: VERIFIED FLEET

- [ ] Advertise through agents, taxi stands and social media
- [ ] Check ID, licence, vehicle and references
- [ ] Register each in the driver or courier app
- [ ] Train on accepting jobs, navigation and customer handling
- [ ] Explain earnings and how wallet payouts work
- [ ] Set a minimum-earnings guarantee for the first weeks

06 Test everything end to end

OWNER: PRODUCT WEEKS 5–7 OUTPUT: TEST REPORT

- [ ] Place real small orders from every merchant
- [ ] Test every payment route: Telebirr, bank, EtelPay, cash if used
- [ ] Test payouts to merchant, courier and driver
- [ ] Test cancellations, refunds and failed payments
- [ ] Run a security check on admin and payment endpoints
- [ ] Take a full backup and rehearse a restore

07 Soft launch with invited customers

OWNER: GROWTH WEEKS 7–10 OUTPUT: FIRST 200 ORDERS

- [ ] Invite friends, staff and nearby offices with a promo code
- [ ] Watch every order live in the admin panel
- [ ] Call customers after delivery to collect feedback
- [ ] Hold a daily 15-minute review of problems
- [ ] Fix the top three issues each week
- [ ] Publish nothing publicly yet

08 Open to the public

OWNER: MARKETING WEEKS 11–14 OUTPUT: PUBLIC LAUNCH

- [ ] Launch on social media with a clear first-order offer
- [ ] Put posters at merchants, taxi stands and campuses
- [ ] Turn on referral rewards
- [ ] Announce through local media and community groups
- [ ] Feature the best merchants
- [ ] Add a welcome message in English and Amharic

09 Improve reliability and retention

OWNER: OPERATIONS WEEKS 14–20 OUTPUT: WEEKLY SCORECARD

- [ ] Review the KPI table every week
- [ ] Remove merchants and drivers with poor ratings
- [ ] Reward top performers
- [ ] Add loyalty rewards and wallet top-up bonuses
- [ ] Shorten dispatch time with better courier positioning
- [ ] Prepare a stronger hosting setup

10 Expand

OWNER: MANAGEMENT MONTH 6+ OUTPUT: GROWTH PLAN

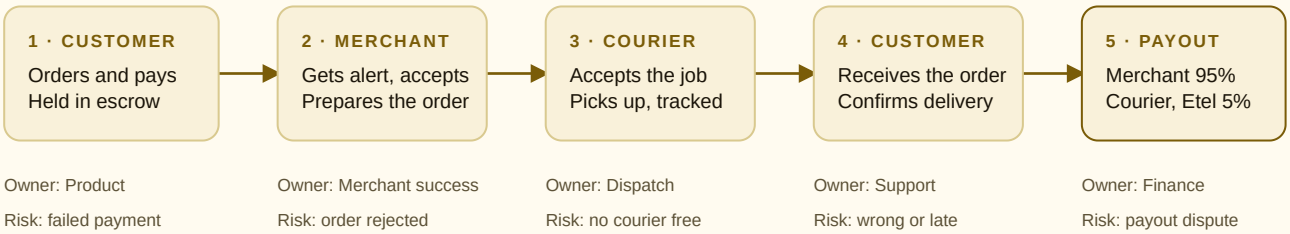
- [ ] Open more districts one at a time
- [ ] Add corporate accounts and merchant advertising
- [ ] Cross-sell Gebeya, Taxi and EtelPay
- [ ] Use the calculator to confirm profit per order
- [ ] Plan funding for the next city
- [ ] Update this playbook with real numbers

HOW IT WORKS

The two core journeys

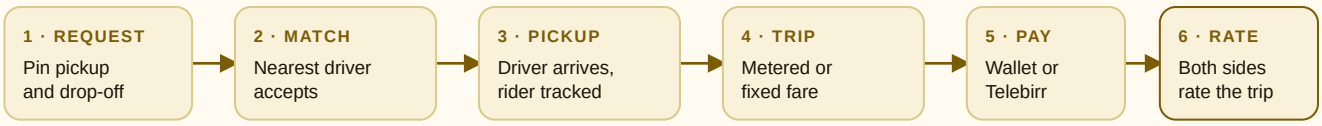
Every order and every ride follows a fixed path. Each hand-off is a place where support, payments or trust can break, so each one needs an owner.

DELIVERY ORDER



Merchant share shown is the order value minus the 5% commission. The courier fee comes from the delivery fee, and the exact split is set in the calculator below.

RIDE

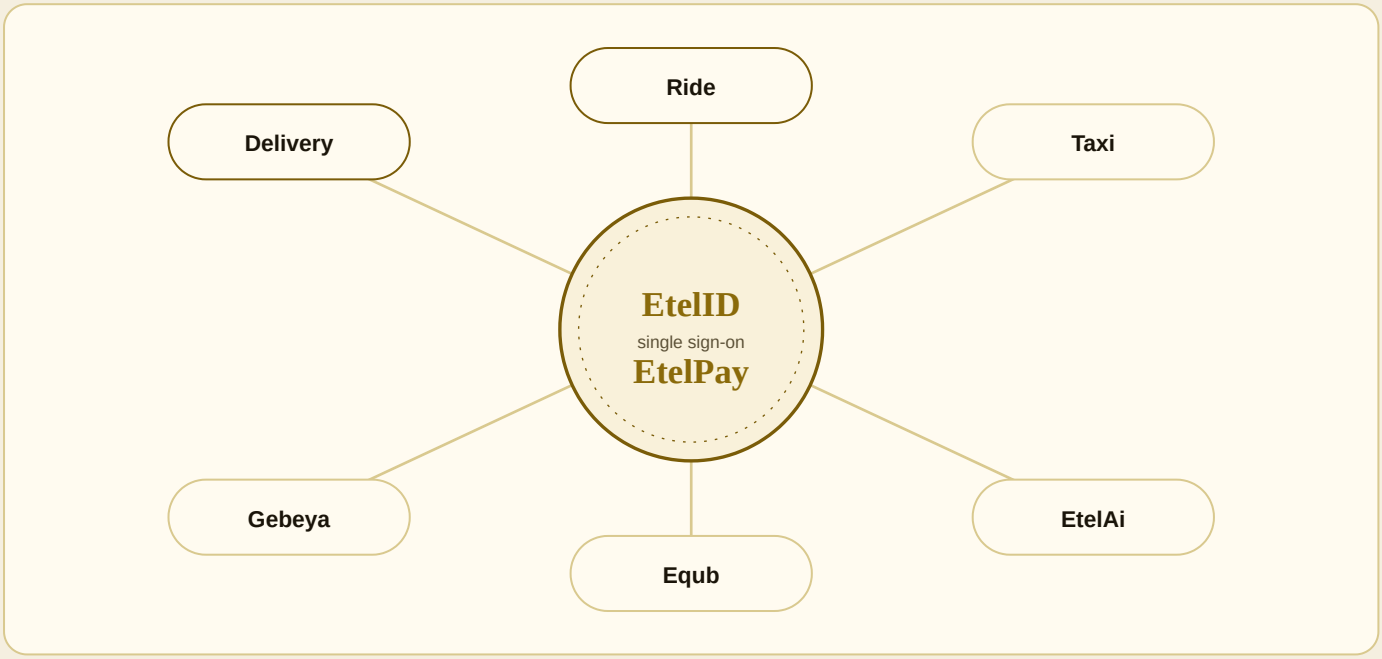


Platform keeps a share of each fare. The rate is still to be set.

WHY ETEL CAN WIN

One identity, one wallet, many services

EtelID and EtelPay sit under every Etel app. A customer who signs up for delivery already has an account and a wallet for rides, the marketplace and taxi.



Gold outlines mark the two services this playbook launches first.

MONEY

Unit economics calculator

Change the example inputs to your real numbers. Nothing here is a forecast; it is a tool to see what has to be true for the business to break even.

INPUTS (EXAMPLE VALUES)

Average order value (ETB)	400
Commission on order (%)	5
Delivery fee charged (ETB)	60
Courier share of fee (%)	80
Orders per day	100
Payment fee per order (ETB)	3
Monthly fixed costs (ETB)	150000

Example figures only. Replace them before making decisions.

RESULT

Commission per order	20 ETB
Delivery margin per order	12 ETB
Payment fee per order	-3 ETB
Contribution per order	**29 ETB**
Monthly contribution (30 days)	87,000 ETB
Monthly fixed costs	-150,000 ETB
Monthly result	**-63,000 ETB**
Break-even orders per day	173



Break-even: 173 or

Current: 100 orders/day

MEASURE

What to track every week

Set a target for each metric with the team before the soft launch. The platform's admin tools and database can report all of these.

METRIC	WHY IT MATTERS	HOW TO MEASURE	TARGET
Orders per day	Demand and revenue driver	Completed orders in the admin panel	[set]
Rides per day	Ride demand	Completed trips	[set]
Active merchants	Supply choice for customers	Merchants with at least one order in 7 days	[set]
Active couriers and drivers	Speed of pickup	Accounts online in 7 days	[set]
Minutes to delivery	Customer trust	Order placed to delivery confirmed	[set]
Repeat customers	Retention	Customers with 2 or more orders in 30 days	[set]
Cancelled or failed orders	Lost revenue and reputation	Cancelled divided by placed	[set]
Contribution per order	Profit health	Calculator above, using real data	[set]

BE READY

Risks and how to handle them

RISK	LEVEL	WHAT TO DO
Too few couriers or drivers, so pickups are slow	High	Recruit ahead of demand, guarantee minimum earnings in the first weeks, launch one district only.

RISK	LEVEL	WHAT TO DO
Merchants do not stay active	High	Weekly visits, fast payouts, show them their order numbers.
Payment or payout errors	High	Test payouts with small real orders before launch, daily reconciliation, clear dispute steps.
Platform downtime on shared hosting	Medium	Backups, uptime alerts, plan a move to stronger hosting before scaling.
Security and data protection	Medium	Keep audits current, limit admin access, review INSA findings.
Competitors copy prices	Medium	Compete on reliability and the one-login, one-wallet experience, not on discounts alone.
Regulation on wallets and ride-hailing	Medium	Confirm licences early with the relevant offices and get advice in writing.

IDENTITY

Brand kit

The mark is an E built from three bars, with a dotted route leaving it and ending at a location pin. It says both things the business does: it moves goods and people.



On carbon



On cream



Carbon	Gold	Bright gold	Deep gold
#0D0B08	#D4AF37	#F2CC6B	#9A7412

Cream
#F5EFE0

Type: Cormorant Garamond for headlines, DM Sans for text. Keep clear space around the mark equal to the width of one bar of the E.